

IDEATION PHASE

Define Problem Statements Template

PS	I am (Customer)	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
PS-1	A Retail Store Manager	Optimize product placement on shelves to maximize sales revenue	I don't know which shelf positions generate the highest sales for different product categories	Customer behavior, foot traffic patterns, and promotional effectiveness vary significantly across categories and seasons	Frustrated and uncertain about inventory and placement decisions
PS-2	A Marketing Analyst	Determine the most effective promotional strategies for different product segments	I cannot easily correlate promotion campaigns with actual sales uplift	Promotional data is scattered and not integrated with sales performance metrics	Overwhelmed by data volume and unable to derive actionable insights
PS-3	A Business Intelligence Lead	Identify pricing strategies that maintain competitive advantage	Competitor pricing data is difficult to compare with our pricing structure	The relationship between our price, competitor price, and sales volume is complex and dynamic	Concerned about losing market share due to suboptimal pricing

Empathy Map Canvas

Target User Persona: Rajesh Kumar | Age: 42 | Occupation: Retail Store Manager | Experience: 15+ years | Location: Urban retail chain

What They SAY	What They THINK
"We need to understand why some products sell better than others." "Promotions aren't giving us the ROI we expected." "Our sales team needs better data to make decisions." "I wish we had more insight into customer behavior." "The manual reporting takes too much time."	"I wonder if shelf position really makes that much difference." "Why does competitor X always seem to have better placement?" "If only I could visualize sales patterns more clearly." "Seasonal trends are killing our inventory planning." "There has to be a smarter way to analyze this data."
What They DO	What They FEEL
Reviews weekly sales reports Manually adjusts shelf placements Analyzes competitor pricing weekly Plans seasonal promotions Conducts periodic store audits	Frustrated with manual analysis Anxious about missing sales opportunities Overwhelmed by data complexity Hopeful that data can provide answers Determined to improve store performance

Pains & Gains:

Pains	Gains
Unable to track product placement effectiveness Manual correlation of sales and placement data Difficulty identifying underperforming products No clear insight into promotional ROI Seasonal demand fluctuations are unpredictable	Wants to maximize sales per square foot Desires automated, interactive dashboards Wants to discover hidden sales patterns Needs to optimize promotional spending Seeks predictive insights for inventory planning

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Step 1: Selection

Retail stores face the ongoing challenge of determining optimal shelf positions and pricing strategies to maximize sales. Product visibility, promotional offers, competitor pricing, and customer preferences all influence purchasing behavior. However, the large volume and complexity of retail data make manual analysis inefficient and error-prone.

Step 2: Brainstorming Ideas

#	Description	#	Description
1	Interactive Tableau Dashboard	9	Foot traffic vs. sales correlation map
2	Mobile app for real-time shelf analytics	10	Product category performance matrix
3	Heat map visualization of placement	11	Store layout optimization tool
4	Automated competitor price comparison	12	Real-time inventory alert system
5	Predictive sales forecasting	13	Price optimization engine
6	Customer segmentation dashboard	14	Customer demographic analysis
7	Promotion effectiveness tracker	15	Supplier performance analytics
8	Seasonal demand trend analyzer	16	Interactive story for presentations

Step 3: Idea Grouping

Group	Ideas	Theme
Visual Analytics	1, 3, 5, 6, 10, 14, 16	Data Visualization & Reporting
Operational Tools	2, 9, 11, 12	Real-time Store Operations
Strategic Analysis	4, 7, 8, 13, 15	Business Intelligence & Optimization

Step 4: Idea Prioritization

Priority	Idea	Impact	Effort	Feasibility	Rationale
1	Interactive Tableau Dashboard	High	Medium	High	Most immediate value; consolidates all analyses
2	Heat map visualization	High	Low	High	Visual clarity for placement decisions
3	Promotion effectiveness tracker	High	Medium	High	Direct ROI measurement
4	Seasonal demand trend analyzer	Medium	Medium	High	Inventory planning support
5	Customer segmentation analysis	Medium	Medium	High	Targeted marketing insights
6	Competitor price comparison	Medium	Low	High	Competitive positioning